

NEXOVA TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

PTO & Leave Policy

Effective Date: January 1, 2025
Document Owner: Human Resources Department
Applies To: All full-time employees — Islamabad, Dubai & London offices
Contact: hr@nexovatech.com

This policy sets out the leave entitlements, accrual rules, and application procedures for all full-time employees of Nexova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. It supersedes all prior leave communications and informal arrangements. Part-time and contractual arrangements are addressed separately. Queries may be directed to hr@nexovatech.com.

Leave Entitlement Summary

The table below provides a quick-reference overview. Full terms for each leave type are detailed in the sections that follow.

Leave Type	Entitlement	Accrual	Carryover	Carryover Deadline	Application Method
Annual Leave (< 2 yrs)	18 days	1.5/mo	5 days	March 31	HRMS
Annual Leave (2–5 yrs)	22 days	1.83/mo	5 days	March 31	HRMS
Annual Leave (5+ yrs)	26 days	2.17/mo	5 days	March 31	HRMS
Sick Leave	10 days	Non-accruing	None	—	HRMS / Verbal
Casual Leave	5 days	Non-accruing	None	—	HRMS
Maternity Leave	16 weeks	After 6 months	N/A	—	HR + Manager
Paternity Leave	2 weeks	All staff	N/A	—	HR + Manager
Unpaid Leave	Up to 3 months	After 1 year	N/A	—	HR + Dept Head
Public Holidays	14 days (PK)	All staff	N/A	—	Auto

Section 1 — Annual Leave

1.1 Entitlement & Accrual

Annual leave entitlement is based on total length of continuous employment at Nexova Technologies:

Tenure Band	Annual Entitlement	Monthly Accrual	Max Carryover
Less than 2 years	18 days	1.50 days/month	5 days
2 to 5 years	22 days	1.83 days/month	5 days
5+ years	26 days	2.17 days/month	5 days

Note: Accrual begins on the first day of employment. Leave accrued during the 3-month probation period cannot be utilised until probation is successfully completed.

1.2 Carryover

- Maximum carryover is 5 days per calendar year.
- Unused leave beyond 5 days lapses automatically on March 31 each year.
- Employees are encouraged to plan leave to avoid lapse. HR will issue a reminder in February.

1.3 Advance Notice Requirements

Leave Duration	Minimum Notice Required	Notes
1 day	1 business day	Subject to manager approval
2–4 days	1 calendar week	Manager approval required
5+ days	3 calendar weeks	Manager + HR approval

1.4 Blackout Periods

Annual leave requests will not ordinarily be approved during the fiscal year-end blackout period:

- December 15 – January 5 (Fiscal Year-End Blackout)

Exceptions require written approval from the relevant Department Head and HR. Employees already on approved leave prior to the blackout declaration are unaffected.

1.5 How to Apply

- All leave requests must be submitted through the Nexova HRMS portal.
- The system routes requests to the direct line manager for approval.
- Requests for 5+ days are escalated to HR for secondary review.
- Employees will receive system-generated email confirmation of approval or denial.
- Requests submitted outside the HRMS are not officially recognised unless HRMS access is unavailable, in which case email to manager and hr@nexovatech.com is acceptable as a temporary measure.

Section 2 — Sick Leave

2.1 Entitlement

- 10 days per calendar year for all full-time employees.

- Sick leave does not accrue, is not carried over, and has no cash value on separation.
- It is non-transferable between employees.

2.2 Medical Certificate

- A medical certificate from a registered practitioner is required for any sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days.
- The certificate must be submitted to hr@nexovatech.com within 2 business days of returning to work.
- Failure to provide documentation may result in the absence being reclassified as unpaid leave.

2.3 Pattern Monitoring

HR monitors patterns of sick leave use. Where a pattern is identified — such as frequent absences on Mondays, Fridays, or the day before or after public holidays — HR may initiate a supportive return-to-work discussion. Repeated unexplained patterns may lead to disciplinary review under the company's 4-stage disciplinary process.

2.4 Long-Term Illness

- Once 10 sick days are exhausted within a calendar year, the employee transitions to medical leave.
- Medical leave beyond 10 days may be treated as unpaid (see Section 6) or, in serious circumstances, may trigger review under the company's long-term illness support framework.
- Employees are encouraged to notify HR as early as possible in cases of prolonged illness.

Section 3 — Casual Leave

- 5 days of casual leave per calendar year for all full-time employees.
- Casual leave cannot be carried over; unused casual leave lapses on December 31.
- A maximum of 2 consecutive casual days may be taken without prior notice in genuine emergencies.
- Same-day applications are accepted via the HRMS portal or email to the line manager and hr@nexovatech.com when genuine urgency prevents advance notice.
- Casual leave may not be combined with annual leave to extend a leave period beyond 5 consecutive calendar days without separate written approval.

Section 4 — Maternity, Paternity & Adoption Leave

4.1 Maternity Leave

- 16 weeks of fully paid maternity leave.
- Eligibility: minimum 6 months of continuous employment at Nexova Technologies at the expected date of delivery.
- Employees should notify HR and their manager at least 8 weeks before the anticipated start date.
- Leave may commence up to 4 weeks before the expected due date; the remaining balance is taken post-delivery.

4.2 Paternity Leave

- 2 weeks of fully paid paternity leave.
- Available to all full-time employees upon the birth of a child.
- Must be taken within 4 weeks of the date of birth.
- Can be taken as a single block or split into two separate weeks with manager agreement.

4.3 Adoption Leave

- Employees adopting a child are entitled to the same leave provisions as above: 16 weeks fully paid (primary caregiver) or 2 weeks fully paid (secondary caregiver).
- Eligibility requirements and notice provisions mirror those for maternity/paternity leave.
- Supporting documentation (legal adoption order or equivalent) must be provided to HR.

4.4 Return-to-Work Plan

- All employees returning from maternity or adoption leave (primary caregiver) must attend a return-to-work planning meeting with their line manager and an HR representative at least 2 weeks before their return date.
- The meeting will cover role continuity, workload adjustment, and any flexible working requests.
- Employees wishing to request a phased return or adjusted hours should submit a formal request to HR at least 4 weeks before their return.

Section 5 — Public Holidays

5.1 Islamabad Office — Pakistani Public Holidays 2025

The Islamabad office observes the following 14 public holidays in 2025. Religious holidays with lunar-calendar dates are provisional and subject to moon sighting confirmation:

Holiday	Date (2025)	Type / Notes
New Year's Day	Jan 1, 2025	National
Kashmir Day	Feb 5, 2025	National
Pakistan Day	Mar 23, 2025	National
Labour Day	May 1, 2025	National
Eid ul-Fitr	Mar 30–31, 2025 (2 days)	Religious — lunar date
Eid ul-Adha	Jun 7–8, 2025 (2 days)	Religious — lunar date
Independence Day	Aug 14, 2025	National
Ashura	Jul 5–6, 2025 (2 days)	Religious — lunar date
Eid Milad-un-Nabi	Sep 5, 2025	Religious — lunar date
Iqbal Day	Nov 9, 2025	National
Quaid-e-Azam Day	Dec 25, 2025	National

Note: Eid ul-Fitr (2 days), Eid ul-Adha (2 days), and Ashura (2 days) each count as 2 holiday days, bringing the total to 14 days across 11 named events.

5.2 Dubai Office

The Dubai office observes UAE federal public holidays. HR will circulate the official UAE holiday schedule annually. Islamic holidays follow the official UAE government announcement. Employees in Dubai should refer to the Dubai-specific leave calendar published in the HRMS portal each January.

5.3 London Office

The London office observes UK Bank Holidays. For 2025, these include New Year's Day, Good Friday, Easter Monday, Early May Bank Holiday, Spring Bank Holiday, Summer Bank Holiday, Christmas Day, and Boxing Day (8 days). Employees in London should refer to the London-specific leave calendar in the HRMS portal.

5.4 Holiday Falling on Weekend

- If a public holiday falls on a Saturday or Sunday, employees are entitled to a compensatory day off on the immediately following Monday (or the next available working day if Monday is also a public holiday).
- Compensatory days must be taken within 30 calendar days and cannot be accumulated or transferred.

Section 6 — Unpaid Leave

6.1 Eligibility & Duration

- Employees must have completed a minimum of 1 year of continuous employment to be eligible for unpaid leave.
- The maximum duration of any single unpaid leave period is 3 calendar months.

6.2 Benefits During Unpaid Leave

- Health and medical benefits continue during approved unpaid leave of up to 30 days.
- For unpaid leave exceeding 30 days, the employee is responsible for co-paying their share of benefit premiums. HR will advise on applicable amounts prior to commencement.
- Annual leave does not accrue during unpaid leave.

6.3 Approval Process

- Requests of up to 30 days: approved by HR and the Department Head.
- Requests exceeding 30 days: require additional written approval from the CEO (Zain ul Abideen).
- All requests must be submitted via the HRMS portal with a written justification and proposed return date at least 4 weeks in advance.

Section 7 — Leave Without Pay (LWOP)

7.1 When LWOP May Be Granted

- LWOP may be considered when: **all paid leave balances have been exhausted**
- The absence is supported by a compelling personal, medical, or family reason.
- Business continuity can be maintained during the employee's absence.
- The employee has a track record of satisfactory performance.

7.2 When LWOP Will Generally Be Denied

- The employee has available paid leave not yet utilised.
- The request coincides with a critical project deadline or blackout period.
- The employee has an active disciplinary warning.
- A similar request was granted within the preceding 12 months.

7.3 Impact on Annual Increment & Performance Review

- LWOP of more than 15 cumulative calendar days within a review year may result in a pro-rated annual increment.
- LWOP in excess of 30 days within a review year will defer the annual performance review by the equivalent duration.
- LWOP does not affect an employee's tenure calculation for leave entitlement purposes, unless it exceeds 60 calendar days in aggregate within a single year.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q: Can I carry over my annual leave if I didn't take it all this year?

A: Yes, but only up to a maximum of 5 days. Any unused annual leave beyond 5 days is forfeited on March 31 each year. HR sends a reminder in February to help you plan.

Q: I joined in September. Can I use my annual leave before the year ends?

A: You begin accruing annual leave from your first day of employment, but you cannot utilise any accrued leave during your 3-month probation period. Once probation is successfully completed, you may apply for leave through the HRMS portal.

Q: I've used all my sick leave but I'm still unwell. What do I do?

A: Once your 10 sick days for the calendar year are exhausted, you may request a transition to unpaid leave (subject to completing 1 year of employment) or explore leave without pay. Please contact hr@nexovatech.com as early as possible so we can discuss options and any applicable support frameworks.

Q: My child was born on a Friday. Can I start paternity leave the following Monday?

A: Yes. Paternity leave must be taken within 4 weeks of the date of birth, so you have flexibility on the start date. Notify your manager and HR as soon as possible, and submit the request in the HRMS portal.

Q: A public holiday falls on a Sunday at our Islamabad office. Do I get a day off in lieu?

A: Yes. When a public holiday falls on a weekend, you are entitled to a compensatory day off on the immediately following Monday (or next working day if Monday is also a holiday). This must be taken within 30 calendar days.

Q: Can I combine casual leave with annual leave to take a longer break?

A: Casual leave may not be combined with annual leave to create a consecutive leave period exceeding 5 calendar days without separate written approval from your manager and HR. If you need a longer break, plan it as a single annual leave request with the required 3-week advance notice.

Q: I need 6 weeks off for personal reasons. What type of leave applies and who approves it?

A: Six weeks is beyond the standard unpaid leave approval threshold of 30 days, which means it requires written approval from the CEO (Zain ul Abideen), in addition to your Department Head and HR. Submit your request at least 4 weeks in advance through the HRMS portal with a full justification.

This policy is issued by the Human Resources Department of Nexova Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Queries: hr@nexovatech.com | ethics@nexovatech.com

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